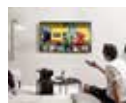




Uber app overhaul

Uber is merging its ride-hailing and food delivery apps and adding a host of new safety features. <https://dgit.in/oct19-43>



OnePlus TVs

The OnePlus TV Q1 is the smartphone maker's first TV, featuring Android TV and running OxygenOS. <https://dgit.in/oct19-44>



Ping, ping, ping!

Agent001 is spoilt for choice between gaming VPN software or GPNS

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amers haven't had it this good in ages. They now have multiple platforms offerings video games

at competitive price points. Exclusivity is still a pain point but it seems the industry is moving ahead regardless. Even hardware manufacturers aside from the ones that make CPUs and GPUs have been baking in gaming related features for quite some time. What was once only limited to the high-end gear is now widely available in the mid-range segment and even in the entry-level segment.

When it comes to improving one's gaming experience, everything matters. Your CPU, RAM and GPU



Netgear XR500

contribute the most, followed by the peripherals that you use and then comes the ancillary things such as the networking and software that you have installed. This is how most gamers tend to prioritise their expenses

and there's nothing wrong with it. Not unless, you're all about online multiplayer gaming. That's when the ancillary things become just as important as the rest of your hardware. We're of course, talking about having a good networking infrastructure.

There's a good portion of networking that's well within your control and there is a lot that you can do little about. With regards to the former, you can have a software QoS solution, a good NIC, proper wired cables or clear line of sight in the case of Wi-Fi, and lastly, a good internet service provider. Having a QoS simply allows you to prioritise all network traffic associated with your gaming to ensure as little packet loss as possible. Then there's the dedicated NIC which frees up the CPU so that it doesn't have to bother with networking packets. Once that's taken care of, your Ethernet cable should be next on your priority. We don't mean that you should get some expensive cables but that your cable should be of proper spec and that the connectors are nice and shiny. The last thing requires a decent amount of effort. If your ISP doesn't have proper routing to whichever data centres host the game servers, then you will have high ping. This can often be resolved by raising a support ticket and having them figure out better routing. Smaller ISPs might not have the abil-

ity to do this but all Tier 1 and Tier 2 ISPs do. Whether they entertain your request is an entirely different matter altogether.

Let's say you've tried everything but you're still experiencing horrible ping. Your only recourse is to figure out a proper VPN that has the best



ASUS ROG RT-AC2900

possible routing from your home to the nearest node to the game server. There's still that last mile connectivity between the VPN's exit node and the game server that's still outside of your control. That's where these specialised VPNs come into play. Some call themselves GPN (Gamers Private Networks). What they do is ensure that the last mile connectivity is also taken care of. They'll speak to the publishers of video games in question and figure out where the game servers are located and set up